

is where real leads come from, far more often than a cold application into an already shrinking market.

Let go of what others think. A lot of good people stay stuck in a shrinking, dying lane far longer than the numbers justify, purely because leaving costs them status. Meet people. Let go of your ego, your prestige. Share your situation.

Now, think about a small income stream

Once your head is clear and your expenses are down, start thinking practically: how could you turn what you genuinely enjoy doing into a small income stream within days, weeks, or a few months? It does not need to be large to begin with. It simply needs to begin.

This need not be another desk job. These are businesses built on trust and personal relationships. They run on reputation and word of mouth. Many people hesitate to take up work that is not seen as glamorous as being a software or hardware engineer. In reality, you can choose almost any profession and make it better by applying the technology you already know—or can learn. That helps you stand out from people who have been doing it for years. There are no ‘levels’ to worry about in a job; the only questions are: Can you do it better than others, do you like doing it, can you get paid for it even a little to start with, and can you expand it over time? Leave behind the status, title, or position you held before. Look at some of the following examples and see if you can start and scale them to bigger heights.

Small starts, real trust

- Food and beverage—A kebab stall, filter coffee counter, tiffin service
- Home services—Electrical work, interior fit-outs, appliance repair
- Land and nature—Gardening, landscaping, small-scale agriculture

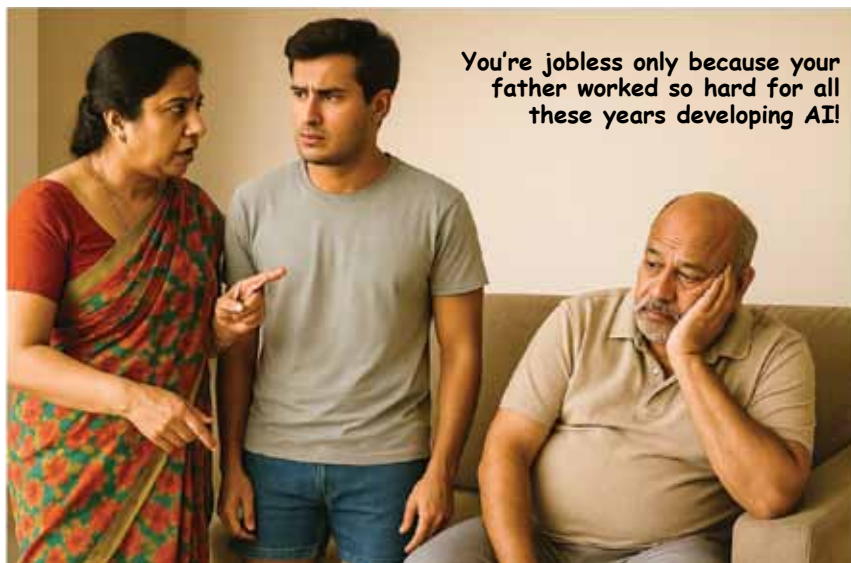


Fig. 2: While this illustration is meant to be a light humour, it reflects a grim reality, as experts are debating the impacts of AI (Source: EFY, Electroons, Aug 2025)

- Guidance and travel—Local trekking or heritage tour guiding
- Local commerce—A small marketing agency or neighbourhood real estate practice

You may want to try it. And know, truly, that it is fine if it fails. At least it sheds the inhibition you might have. It removes that ‘stage fear’ and enables you to uncover your strengths.

Vinod Khosla, who went on to co-found Sun Microsystems and later built one of the most successful venture funds in the world, did not start with success. In 1975, fresh out of IIT Delhi, he tried to start a soy milk company, a milk alternative for Indian households that had no refrigeration. It failed. Funding did not come through. Infrastructure worked against him at every step; the waiting time to get a phone connection was seven years back then.

That failure did not define Vinod Khosla. It redirected him toward Carnegie Mellon, toward Stanford, toward Silicon Valley, toward everything that came after. The lesson is not that failure guarantees success later. It is that even the most capable people’s first tries commonly fail, and the failure itself carries no verdict about the person.

The lesson you already learned once

Think about something even closer to home than Khosla’s story. You would not be walking today if you had been afraid of falling while learning to walk. You fell many times as a child. By any definition, those were failures. But you were not ashamed then. You did not wait for someone to applaud before standing up again. You did not give up because you fell. You never stopped to wonder what others thought. That child within you already knew how to do this. Your task now is simply to remember.

In summary, every shake-up, shock, and disruption is an opportunity to bring out the best in you. Take time to think clearly. Find what you genuinely enjoy. Turn it into something small and real. Do not give too much importance to what others think; this is one of the most important lessons in our closely knit societies. Expect a stumble or two along the way. Then get up anyway, exactly as you did before.

You are not alone. Thousands, or even millions, may be going through this right now. As wise people have often said, “Dream big, everything else will fall into place.” **EFY**